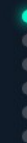


MARCH 2026 INDEX

TIOBE Index March 2026

How 20+ Search Engines Rank the World's Programming Languages

Based on search-engine hit counts across Google, Bing, Wikipedia, Amazon, and 20+ other sites



Python Holds #1 at 21.25% but C Surges to #2 with the Largest Gain

2026	2025	Language	Rating	YoY
1	1	Python	21.25%	-2.59%
2	4	C	11.55%	+2.02%
3	2	C++	8.18%	-2.90%
4	3	Java	7.99%	-2.37%
5	5	C#	6.36%	+1.49%
6	6	JavaScript	3.45%	-0.01%
7	9	Visual Basic	2.50%	-0.02%
8	8	SQL	2.00%	-0.57%
9	16	R	1.88%	+0.94%
10	10	Delphi/Object Pascal	1.80%	-0.36%
11	24	Perl	1.75%	+1.05%

Perl Jumps 13 Spots, R Climbs 7, and Go Drops 9 -- The Biggest Rank Shifts of 2026

▲ Rising Stars

Perl 24th → 11th +13
R 16th → 9th +7
Swift 26th → 20th +6
C 4th → 2nd +2

▼ Declining

Go 7th → 16th -9
C++ 2nd → 3rd -1
Java 3rd → 4th -1
Kotlin Out of Top 20 -2

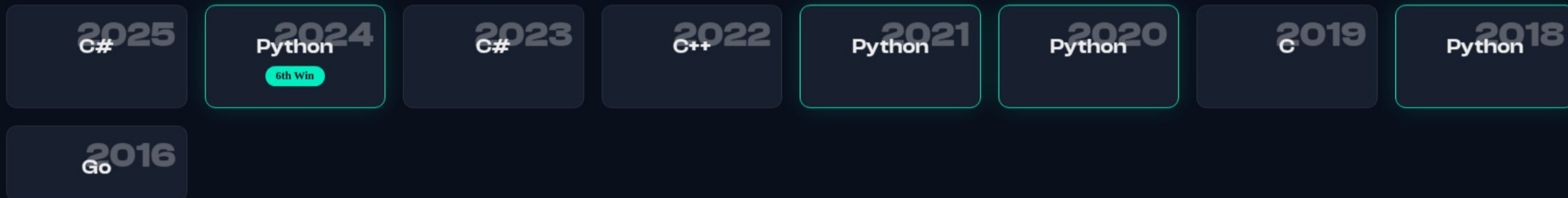


From Lisp at #2 in 1986 to Python at #1 in 2026: How Language Rankings Shifted Over Time

Language	2026	2021	2016	2011	2006	2001	1996	1991	1986
Python	1	3	5	7	8	26	17	-	-
C	2	1	2	2	2	1	1	1	1
C++	3	4	3	3	3	2	2	2	9
Java	4	2	1	1	1	3	31	-	-
C#	5	5	4	5	7	11	-	-	-
JavaScript	6	7	8	10	10	8	33	-	-
Go	10	11	60	16	-	-	-	-	-
Ada	14	36	25	22	16	18	6	10	3
Lisp	26	34	26	13	14	19	8	4	2

C is the only language to remain in the top 2 across all nine measurement points spanning four decades.

Python Wins Language of the Year 6 Times -- More Than Any Other Language



Note: Python has won Language of the Year award 6 times total (2007, 2010, 2018, 2020, 2021, 2024). Go's 2016 win preceded its current decline from 7th to 16th.

The Top 4 Languages Hold 49% of the Index: What This Means for Your Tech Stack

Python's Dominance vs. Decline

At 21.25%, Python leads by wide margin, but its **-2.59% YoY drop** is the largest among top 5. Monitor this trajectory.

C's Resurgence

C gained **+2.02%** and climbed from 4th to 2nd. Systems programming momentum is shifting back to C.

Legacy Language Revival

Perl (+13 ranks), R (+7), and Fortran remain strong in their niches: scripting, data analysis, and scientific computing.

Go's Sharp Fall

Go dropped **-9 positions** (7th to 16th), possibly displaced by Rust in systems programming.

Concentration Risk

49% of the index is held by just Python,

C, C++, and Java. Don't bet everything on one language.

